

How can we be forest rich and timber poor?

America abounds with forests that can be cut and regrown, generation after generation, forever. There need be no shortage of standing timber now, or ever. But if this is true, why do we face the prospect of higher prices for wood products?

In spite of our forest resources, America is threatened by a serious wood shortage in the midst of abundance, because our national forests are tragically under-managed, underfinanced and overregulated.

Present government policies actually impede the cutting of timber in a time of growing demand. There are plenty of trees for harvest but they're being wasted. And that creates the artificial shortage that drives prices up.

The federal government with control of more than half the nation's standing timber, has failed to give us a comprehensive, long-range policy for use of the national forests.

You suffered through the oil shortage and paid the price for America's lack of vision. Yet we still have no coherent, long-range energy policy.

Now the same thing may happen to our wood supplies, and Congress and the Administration hesitate to propose bills to prevent it. If they stall much longer, you'll start to feel the pinch in scarce wood and paper supplies and spiraling prices. In the end, a timber shortage could cause consumers to turn to non-renewable substitutes such as steel, aluminum and plastic.

Repercussions of this shortage would hit all segments of our national economy—housing, jobs, manufacturing foreign trade. Sortages would rekindle the fire of inflation.

Many laws that regulate commercial timber harvest on national forests are obsolete; some date back to the 19th century. Present laws actually prevent the

use of scientific forest management practices which could nearly double the tree harvest from the 92 million acres of federally-owned commercial forests.

Nearly six billion board feet of softwood dies and rots each year for lack of care. That's half the amount that's actually harvested. And too many trees are being removed from the timber supply by closing off national forest lands to cutting.

Obviously, it's in the national interest to set aside certain forest lands for wilderness, recreation and conservations. But recently the pendulum has swung too far in one direction and land is being set aside to lie fallow and unproductive for any purpose. In addition, the government has made no provision to intensify management on the remaining lands so they can produce more timber per acre to make up for the loss.

Government lands are supplying 27 percent of the nation's softwood timber need while containing 52 percent of the country's total inventory of softwood sawtimber. In contrast, the forest industry's softwood inventory comprises only 16 percent of nation's total, yet supplies 34 percent of all sawlogs.

These circumstances lead to one conclusion: As an American, you aren't getting your money's worth from our nation's treasure of forests. Obviously, we're not planning for future timber supplies—we're not planning for future timber supplies—we're not planning the future of the environment to the next century and beyond. We need a national timber policy.

Needed funds for the Forest Service won't burden the federal budget or come out of your tax dollars. The forest industries who harvest the trees pay the bill when they buy the trees from the government.

Try Classifieds

ANTIQUE AUCTION

SATURDAY JAN. 15th
1:00 P.M. SHARP
MORLEY ANTIQUE SHOP
Downtown Main St. Morley, Mich.
Easy to find, lots of free parking

"FURNITURE"

2 Bookcase Secretaries - oval glass, round walnut table, large maple wardrobe, cane seat rocker, cherry rocker, square oak table, maple commode, maple washstand, Oak dresser with mirror (by Celent), fainting couch, walnut dresser, oak lamp table, bonnet dresser, kitchen cabinet with roll, youth and rocking chair, combination, 2 oak rockers, Morris chair, small maple wardrobe, oak bed, walnut bed, maple bed, iron bed with brass knobs, buffet, oak side board, 3 drawer oak chest, child's tilt front desk, many odd kitchen chairs, corner wardrobe.

"ADVERTISING"

Cardboard - Union leader, wood frame, Uncle Sam reading newspaper, 21 1/2 in. x 29 1/2 in. cardboard-Brotherhood, Wood frame, steam engine with laborer sitting on left, man with top hat on right, 21 1/2" x 29 1/2", Cardboard, mixture, wood frame, 2 Civil War buddies, copyright 1899 - 22 1/2" x 32 1/2", Tin redman, tobacco sign, wood beer cases - Nu Bru, Peterson Beverage, Huebner Toledo, all rough.

"COAL & WOOD STOVES"

Small Pot belly, all cast iron, small cook stove believed to be salesman sample, height 24 1/2" width 22" depth 18"; Medium size Peerless Small Oakland laundry stove, Kalamazoo Emperor blue porcelain cook stove, round oak chief cook stove.

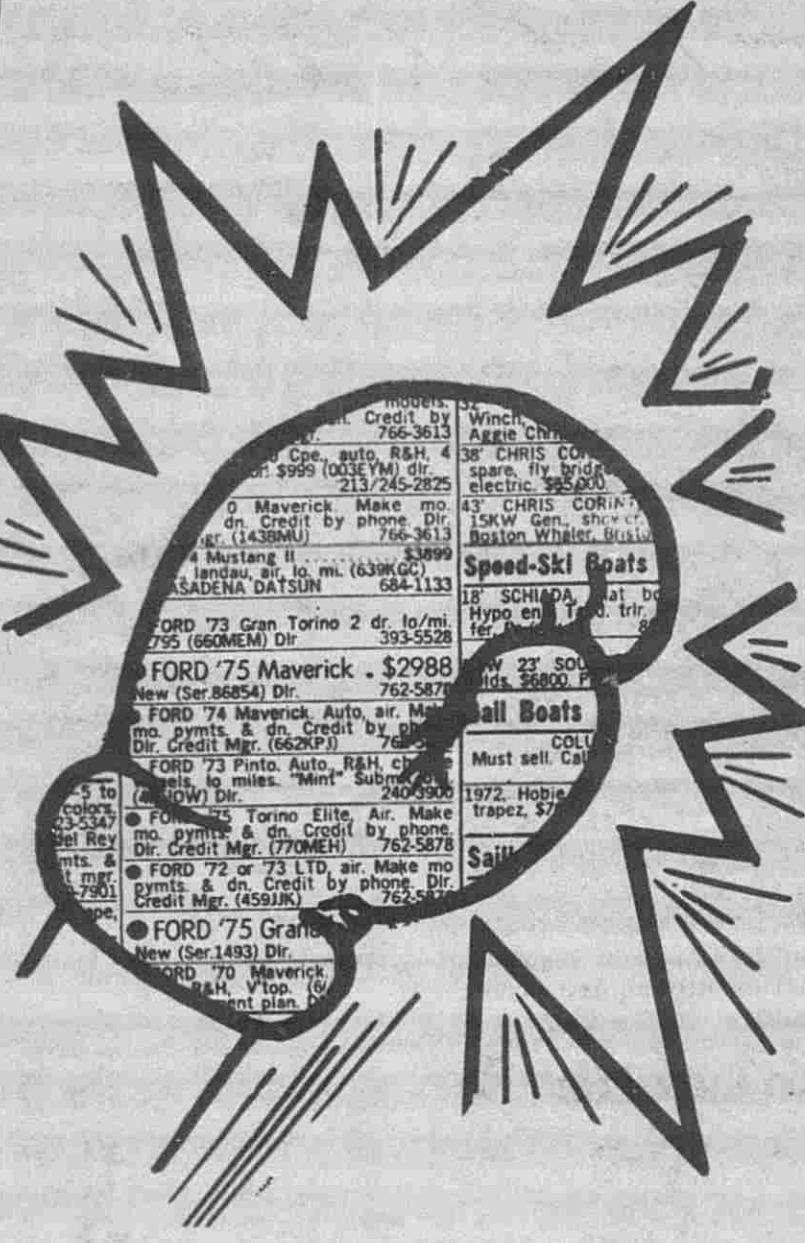
"PINE PRIMITIVES"

China Cupboard with glass doors, large and ugly 2 kitchen cupboards, round drop leaf table, Jelly cupboard, 3 trunks or tool boxes, small three (3) drawer chest, large three (3) drawer chest.

"MISCELLANEOUS"

Small group of glassware, silver plate teapot. Sugar and Creamer, several lanterns, brass blow torch, several pocket watches, wicker buggy, brass chandelier, wood barrel, barrel churn, corn sheller, many odd pictures with ornate frames, old tools, pitcher pump, 10 gal. crock, lots of small collectables and crudd too numerous to mention.

AUCTIONEER — GORDON UTTER



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